

2_INTRODUCTION TO DESIGN THINKING

In this Use Case, I will identify the user for this app feature, and attempt to solve the design problem by coming up with a creative solution, based on the requirements of the user.

The design problem for this brief, is to design an app to offer a way to customers to make payments in an easily accessible, safe and convenient way, exclusively when they travel.

Mobile card payments have long been around, and are a convenient way to use our mobile devices to make payments without having to use a physical bank card. This technology, although it did not replace the need for physical bank cards, had been a hugely helpful feature as it offers a new flexible payment method, which is always at hand, and as it is digital, cannot be damaged or lost in the same way.

WomenBank has an existing mobile banking app with the typical features, such as financial information, statements, transfers, blocking stolen cards etc.

However, WomenBank has detected that customers are finding the Credit/Debit card system inconvenient when travelling, and they would like to develop a feature in the app where customers have the option to use the app at the point of purchase rather than a physical card to make payments.

The app can be logged into using personal credentials. It is envisioned that the customer will not need to enter any additional data when paying or checking out. Rather it will be a quick and easy process. The goal is to offer customers a more convenient and innovative way to save and manage money, when travelling.

In an effort to gain insight into the needs of the user and use my empathy skills to find out more, I set up a short interview which would start a conversation about the limitations and difficulties currently being faced.

During the interviews, I uncovered some interesting insights which I did not expect. Though I thought I had a clear idea of what the problem was, I realised there was more than one problem.

Most of the people I interviewed used their credit/debit card when travelling, with a small amount of cash alongside it. Surprisingly, although they were worried about losing the cash, none of the interviewees listed losing their card as a primary concern. I was a little surprised by this, as this was the main method of payment, and even a blocked card would require time to replace, if anything were to go wrong.

The other concern that came up was that customers often forgot to inform their bank that they were travelling, which meant that the bank often would block customers from using the card, which could only be sorted out after trying to get on the phone with the bank from another country which was a hassle in itself. Other card issues, such as the card not working in certain situations was another struggle.

During the interview, the issue of currency conversion and additional bank rates came up, however it seems that customers do not see this as something that can be improved very easily, and so have resolved to accept it.

Around the subject of currency conversion, and bank charges, some of the ones interviewed said that they used a currency card before and that it was helpful as the rates were good. However they were often paranoid about hidden charges and found it a hassle to renew once the card was expired.

As for carrying cash, most of the people interviewed made sure to convert some cash before they left, by physically walking around and checking for the best rate from provider to provide. Others checked online through a comparison site, before going to the provider physically to exchange the cash. Some chose to pick up the currency at the airport, by prearranging the amount and securing a good rate. For some countries, it was more convenient or possible to convert the cash once they had arrived, and finally some people waited to take out cash once they had arrived in their destination and left the airport.

Define

I found the cash conversion issue is the biggest problem at hand. It causes many inconveniences and security issues. It is often out of people's way and requires planning, which is stressful and difficult.

I believe that there should be a way for customers to be able to convert their cash virtually through their bank app. This idea may sound a little out of the box, however based on my conversations with the interviewees, I strongly feel that this would be a very popular feature which would entice many customers. Any profit margins can be built into the price of the service which can be optional and customers can be charged an annual fee to have access to this unique feature.

Another important feature I want to make sure to add is an instant chat box for users who are having difficulty paying, or having any other difficulty, as this is one of the inconveniences people face when using their bank card in another country.

Ideate

Some ideas I came up with to solve the problem I have defined are as follows:

Idea 1: Create a virtual currency card with the ability to purchase currency online

Idea 2: Use a card that offers users the possibility of using a digital currency to make payments. The bank will allow customers to purchase digital currencies and keep these currencies in a separate wallet, to be used when travelling or for any other reason.

Idea 3: Use a QR system to allow currency exchange providers to deposit currency directly into the virtual currency card

Develop: How would it work?

Chosen Idea: Create a virtual currency card

The idea is to create an additional service (possibly optional) within the existing bank app. This service is a currency card. As the rates offered by banks are usually not very enticing, the customer would be able to purchase currency through the app.

In simpler terms, the bank would act as a broker allowing customers to purchase currency from a choice of currency exchange providers. The customer will first select the currency they are looking to exchange, then they will be presented with a few choices of providers. The customer will then select their preference and proceed to purchase the currency. The customer can also toggle a switch that activates the automatic best rate selection option. The purchased currency will then be added to the bank card.

The customer will be able to see their digital card on the bank app, where it can be easily used to make transactions using inbuilt the contactless technology. The customer also has the option of adding the card to their device.

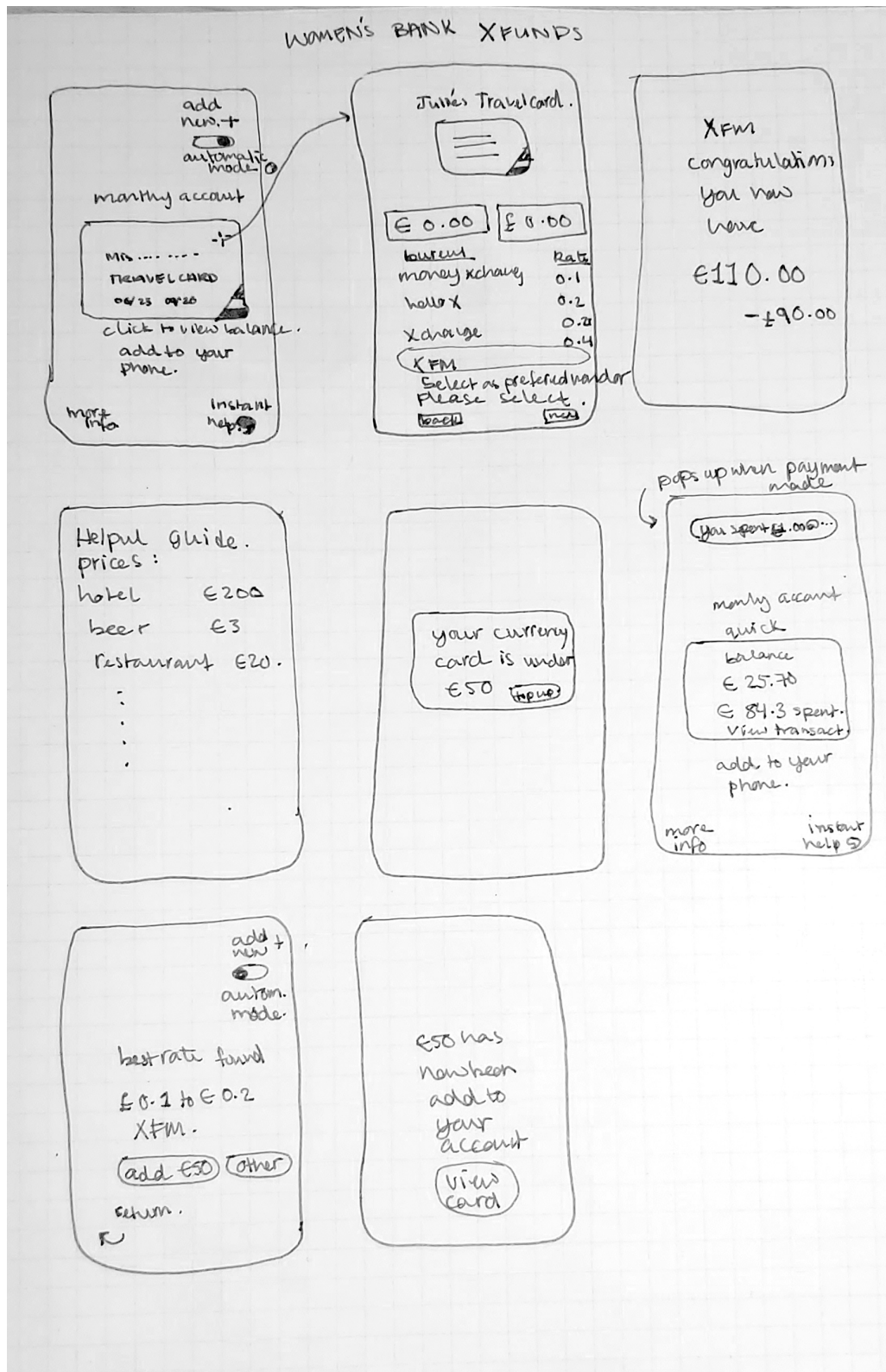
Rather than having more than one card for different currencies, they will have one currency card, and a wallet showing the different currencies, and the funds available. The customer can easily switch between currencies by clicking and then confirming the change, perhaps with the pin code, enabling them to use the currency they need, safely, at any particular time.

What I learned

What I learned from this design exercise is that the solution is not the first idea that makes sense. By taking a step back and listening to what people had to say, I realised that the solution was connected to the problem, but first the problem needs to be defined. Speaking to the user gives a better idea of the problem.

I also learned that users are sometimes resolved to the fact that some things will always be the same and cannot be improved, and it is important to have a positive mindset and being open to new possibilities.

Prototype



Wireframe Sketch